

# Fivetran + dbt Labs Onboarding

---

45-minute walkthrough for a new employee starting the dbt Academy course

---

## BEFORE THE MEETING (YOUR PREP)

---

- ☐ Have a real or sandbox Fivetran connector already synced to an MDLS (or equivalent) destination, connected to a dbt Cloud project with bronze/silver/gold scaffolded.
- ☐ Confirm his Fivetran and dbt Cloud accounts exist and have access to the sandbox project you'll demo.
- ☐ Have the dbt Academy course site open in a browser tab, on Session 1.
- ☐ Be ready to explain, in your own words: why dbt sits downstream of Fivetran, and what dbt Wizard's actual differentiator is.

## MEETING AGENDA (45 MINUTES)

---

- ① **Quick access check** — 2 min
  - Have him log into Fivetran and confirm he can see a dashboard.
  - Have him log into dbt Cloud and open the IDE for the sandbox project — confirm he sees models/, seeds/, macros/, tests/, and dbt\_project.yml.
  - If either fails, pause and resolve access before continuing.
- ② **Why this matters** — 5 min
  - Fivetran syncs raw data; dbt transforms it into something a prospect recognizes as their own business.
  - Every ODI demo he touches follows this pattern.
  - Tell him explicitly: interrupt anytime, this is not a lecture.
- ③ **The big picture: one data flow** — 8 min
  - Walk the single sentence the whole course hangs off of: Fivetran sync → MDLS destination (S3 + Glue) → bronze sources.yml → silver staging views → gold Iceberg tables.
  - Stay at a conceptual level here — no syntax yet.
  - Maps to Sessions 2 and 3 he'll complete on his own.
- ④ **Live look at dbt Cloud** — 7 min
  - Screen-share the sandbox project.
  - Show Development vs. Deployment environments.
  - Show the Cloud IDE file tree, then click through the docs DAG.
  - This is Session 1's checkpoint — seeing it once speeds up his solo pass.
- ⑤ **Live look at bronze / silver / gold** — 10 min
  - Show one real bronze sources.yml, one staging model (stg\_[source]\_\_[table].sql), and one gold model with Iceberg config.
  - Run *dbt build --select bronze silver gold* live so he sees a real build succeed.
  - Expect questions on naming conventions and why bronze does no renaming.

**6 dbt Wizard teaser** — 10 min

- Run a live dbt-wizard session against the sandbox, or use the course site's Wizard Console replay as a fallback.
- Ask a real business question in plain English.
- Narrate the sequence: search → describe → lineage → warehouse → dbt\_compile → dbt\_run.
- Emphasize: nothing touches the warehouse until he approves the compiled preview.

**7 Handoff: how the course works** — 5 min

- Show the site: six one-hour sessions plus two bonus deep-dives (content rules, live-demo troubleshooting).
- Each session has a goal, steps, a checkpoint, and an "if something breaks" section.
- Expectation: work Sessions 1–6 in order, at his own pace, actually completing each checkpoint.
- Point him to the cheat sheet as a second-tab reference.

**PACING NOTE**

Questions are expected throughout — don't save them for the end. Leave 1–2 minutes of slack built into each step above and invite questions as you go, rather than budgeting a separate Q&A block you likely won't reach.

---

Course reference: dbt Academy — Mid-Atlantic SE Team (six sessions: dbt Cloud Refresher, Bronze/Silver/Gold, Fivetran → dbt MDLS, dbt Wizard, CI/CD & Demo Narrative, Flagship Build; plus two bonus deep-dives).